



NEXT CHAPTER @ SMITH PUBLIC LIBRARY

Welcome to Your Path Forward

Session 1 — Orientation, Diagnostic & Getting Started

Monday Evenings • 5:30–7:30 PM • Library Conference Room

You're in the Right Place



Turn to someone near you and share:

- 1 Your first name
- 2 One thing you're hoping to get out of this program
- 3 One thing that makes you nervous about it (we've all got one!)

You are not the only adult in this room starting over. Every single person here made the same call you did.



Michelle Bellamy

Your Instructor

MS ITM Program Director at UT Dallas, with a background across Goldman Sachs, EY, Google, and IBM.

A Few Ground Rules

- **Progress, not perfection.** You're building, not being graded on where you are today.
- **Mistakes are data.** A wrong answer just tells us what to work on next.
- **You set the pace.** Job, kids, life — we'll work with your reality, not against it.

How This Program Works



Monday Class

2 hours, in person, every week.



Thursday Office Hours

1 hour, optional, virtual.



Take-Home Practice

Short, self-paced, between sessions.



Math → RLA → Science → Social Studies, one subject at a time this year

Tonight's Agenda

1

Welcome, instructor intro & ground rules

15 min

2

How the program works

10 min

3

Meet the GED test format

15 min

4

GED Ready diagnostic (all 4 subjects)

25 min

5

Understanding your results

20 min

6

Set your goal & study skills

25 min

7

Wrap-up & what to expect next week

10 min



What is “GED Ready”?

It's a practice test — not the real thing.

Tonight's diagnostic tells us where you're starting from. It doesn't count toward anything or cost you anything.

Think of it as a starting line, not a test you can fail. We'll go over your results together tonight, right after.

A Sneak Peek at the Test Format

The GED is taken on a computer. Here are the four main question styles:



Multiple Choice

Click the best answer from a list.



Drop-Down

Choose the correct answer from a drop-down menu.



Fill in the Blank

Type a short answer or number directly.



Select-an-Area

Click and select the part of a passage that answers the question.



Let's Get Started!

Time for the GED Ready diagnostic — take your time, do your best, and remember: this doesn't count against you.



Understanding Your Results

This is not a grade.

Your results sort into three bands per subject — they just tell us where to spend our time together.

Foundational: we'll build from the ground up together.

Developing: you've got real groundwork — we'll build on it.

Strong Start: you're ready to move quickly through this subject.

Let's Set Your Goal

Open the take-home tool's Goals tab and fill this in



Why are you here?

One honest sentence — a job, your kids, yourself. Write it down.



When do you want to finish?

Pick a real month. It doesn't have to be perfect — it just has to exist.

A goal you can see is a goal you can hit. We'll check back in on this all year.

Study Skills That Actually Work



Take Notes By Hand

Writing things out — even messy — helps it stick better.



Spread It Out

20 minutes a few nights a week beats one long cram session.



Use Office Hours

Thursday nights are built for exactly this — don't sit stuck all week.

Before You Go



Attendance

Miss no more than 1 class per subject block to stay eligible for free official practice tests.



Communication

I'll email reminders and updates weekly — keep an eye on your inbox.



Try the take-home practice

10 minutes, any time this week — same format we just practiced tonight.



Great First Night.

See you next Monday — Math begins.

Before next week:

Try the take-home practice tool. Want more? GED.com's free test preview tutorials (tools.ged.com) are always open, in English or Spanish.